

Dr. Gaurav Chauhan

Public Health Program & Policy Leader | Government Health Systems | Stakeholder Engagement | Quality Assurance & M&E

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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Public health program and policy expert with 15+ years of experience spanning national-level health policy advisory (National Health Authority, National Health Mission, Ministry of Health & Family Welfare), state-level program implementation across four Indian states (Madhya Pradesh, Rajasthan, Bihar, Haryana) and clinical work. Extensive track record navigating State and National Government health departments, including direct engagement with Joint Secretary-level leadership at the National Health Authority on health-financing reform (AB PM-JAY) under an Asian Development Bank technical assistance engagement. Background includes health-system quality-assurance work (NQAS certification support), workforce training and capacity-building at multi-state scale (14 intervention states under a USAID-funded health systems strengthening project), digital health data systems (DHIS2, HMIS, MCTS, ODK), and public-private partnership market-access work with a global pharmaceutical company. Skilled at translating technical and programmatic findings into government-ready reports, policy guidelines, and reform frameworks, and at building consensus among government, development-partner, and institutional stakeholders.

CORE COMPETENCIES

- Government & Multi-Stakeholder Engagement (State & National Health Departments, Development Partners, NGOs)
- Health Systems Strengthening & Public Health Policy
- Quality Assurance Systems (NQAS) & Health-Facility Certification Support
- Workforce Training, Capacity Building & Mentoring at Multi-State Scale
- Program & Project Management (Budget Coordination, Work Planning, HR, Procurement)
- Monitoring & Evaluation (M&E) and Digital Health Data Systems (DHIS2, HMIS, MCTS, ODK)
- Health Financing & Scheme Reform (AB PM-JAY)
- Public-Private Partnerships & Market Access
- Policy, Guideline & Technical Report Development
- Non-Communicable Disease, RMNCH+A, Nutrition & Immunization Programs

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Consultant (Program Manager) – AB PM-JAY and Senior Strategic Support Expert | National Health Authority, Government of India

September 2025 – Present • New Delhi

Providing specialized technical support for reforms to India's national health financing scheme (Ayushman Bharat Pradhan Mantri Jan Arogya Yojana), working closely with NHA teams, development partners, and stakeholders on policy integration and performance monitoring.

- Engaged directly by the Joint Secretary overseeing AB PM-JAY to support an **Asian Development Bank technical assistance engagement**, serving as Senior Strategic Support Expert (Population and Health Services).
- **Authored a Strategic Challenges and Gaps Report, Inception Report, Solutions and Action Plans Report, and Final Report** designing a revised scheme framework, incorporating international benchmarking.
- **Led and supported development of revised scheme guidelines for AB PMJAY**, including revised guidelines of District-Implementation Unit, Portability, AB PMJAY Operational Manual, and financial guidelines for utilization of ASHA/AWW/AWH funds under the scheme.
- **Supported expediting the fund utilization under the scheme**, through coordination with State.
- Led structured consultations with national and state government stakeholders and development-partner teams to build consensus on proposed reforms, synthesizing technical findings into policy-ready recommendations.
- Support strategic analysis, gap identification, and reform incorporation to strengthen universal health coverage and address healthcare access gaps.

Health Systems Partner – Access | Roche India

September 2024 – August 2025 • Madhya Pradesh

- Led development and execution of **market-access strategy** in the state to support equitable, cost-effective availability of innovative therapies for rare and non-communicable diseases.
- Built and maintained strategic relationships with health functionaries, payers, and key opinion leaders to inform healthcare policy and reimbursement discussions — relevant experience in **public-private coordination and stakeholder alignment**.
- Partnered with health-economics teams to assess and communicate value propositions, using evidence-based data to inform market-access and adoption decisions.
- Delivered regular data-driven reporting on access barriers, market trends, and policy developments to inform strategic decision-making.
- Advocated for policy changes with governmental and regulatory bodies to support a favourable environment for patient access to innovative therapies.

Senior Program Officer, USAID-Supported NISHTHA Project | Jhpiego India

April 2022 – September 2024 • New Delhi

NISHTHA was a USAID-funded Health System Strengthening project. Served as thematic lead for Urban Health, AYUSH at Primary Care, and Quality Assurance, representing Jhpiego on national and state stakeholder forums.

- **Provided technical and thought leadership across 14 intervention states**, planning strategy, coordinating implementation, and liaising with international, national, and subject-matter experts.
- **Led the project and coordinated technical assistance for NQAS process-acceleration tools** supporting Sub Health Centre (Ayushman Arogya Mandir) certification, working across NHSRC, state leads, USAID, and field experts (2024).
- Supported Project Leadership (Director and Deputy Chief of Party) on budget coordination, donor/HQ updates, and project governance, including development of the project charter.
- Mentored state project teams on strategy, action-plan development, and monitoring; mobilized technical assistance including Statements of Work, Terms of Reference, and digital tools/dashboards.
- Oversaw project M&E, periodic reporting, and review against the approved work plan; supported new program development through proof-of-concept and proposal writing.
- Coordinated recruitment, onboarding, and capacity building of key national and state positions.

Senior Consultant, PG Medical Education Board (PGMEB) | National Medical Commission, Ministry of Health & Family Welfare, Government of India

September 2021 – March 2022 • New Delhi

- Provided technical assistance for planning and strengthening of India's PG Medical Education regulatory system.
- **Supported the President-PGMEB and Deputy Secretary** in planning, coordinating, and executing PG Board meetings, including drafting agendas and recording minutes; facilitated consultations with expert groups, state stakeholders, and legal departments.
- Assisted in drafting and reviewing PGME regulations and policies, and coordinated with other NMC boards to resolve overlapping issues.
- Mentored team members and supported appraisal of Teachers' Eligibility Qualification applications; managed documentation of PG-seat recognition records for FY 2021–22.

Consultant, Public Health Policy & Planning | National Health Mission, Ministry of Health & Family Welfare, Government of India

August 2018 – September 2021 • New Delhi

- Coordinated across national program divisions (NCD, NTEP, NVBDCP, NPPC, NPHCE, IDSP, NACO, NUHM, and others) to collate inputs on States' Program Implementation Plans for presentation to and approval by the National Program Coordination Committee.
- Provided technical assistance for decentralized planning and health-system strengthening in allocated states, including implementation of NRHM/ECRP/15th Finance Commission provisions.
- Supported NHM budgeting and financial planning for assigned states to align with national resource priorities; built state capacity to review and improve health plans using epidemiological and HMIS data.
- Provided technical inputs thematic areas - Swachh Swasth Sarvatra, Mera Aspataal, and Health & Wellness Centre initiatives; conducted program-monitoring and supportive-supervision field visits.
- Liaised with inter-ministerial stakeholders (MHA, DoNER, Jal Shakti, AYUSH) and supported the Joint Secretary (Policy) on assigned priorities.

Programme Coordinator, Regional Centre of Excellence for Nutrition Rehabilitation, Resource & Training (RCoENRRT) | All India Institute of Medical Sciences (AIIMS), Bhopal

December 2017 – August 2018 • Bhopal, Madhya Pradesh

- Provided planning, budgeting, capacity-building, and knowledge-management support to strengthen facility- and community-based management of Severe Acute Malnutrition (SAM) across Madhya Pradesh.
- **Conducted phased training programs for Medical Officers and Feeding Demonstrators** across the state's Nutrition Rehabilitation Centres (NRCs) on management of complex/non-responder SAM cases.
- Provided techno-managerial support to operational research and pilot studies conducted under RCoENRRT, and supported inter-departmental coordination among AIIMS, state nutrition and health departments, UNICEF, and NHM.
- Co-authored a chapter in the Guidance Document on SAM Children's Advanced Care (AIIMS Bhopal, 2018) and supported establishment of the Centre's training facility through streamlined actions on administrative bottlenecks.

Deputy Programme Manager, Community-Based Management of Acute Malnutrition (CMAM) | ACF (Action Contre la Faim / Action Against Hunger) India

September 2016 – August 2017 • Jaipur, Rajasthan

- Provided technical and managerial support to NHM-Rajasthan for CMAM program implementation, including logistics, financial, and human-resource management.
- Reviewed and updated program guidelines, developed training packages, analyzed training needs, and built technical capacity within the team and NHM.
- Conducted field visits to identify implementation gaps and supported advocacy and fundraising activities through technical inputs for donor engagement.

Project Coordinator, Embrace India Program (Funded & Supported by UNICEF) | Thrive Networks

April 2016 – August 2016 • Gaya & Purnea, Bihar

- Led project implementation across two Bihar districts - data collection, health-worker training, quality-improvement activities, and logistics management for medical devices.
- Oversaw and mentored Site Managers and Site Coordinators teams to ensure onsite training quality and protocol adherence; developed district work plans and training materials; engaged NHM, UNICEF, NGO, and ASHA stakeholders to support local program adoption.

Coordinator, Child Health | National Health Mission (NHM), Haryana

February 2014 – March 2016 • Haryana

- Planned, executed, and supervised child-health programs across the facility network (District Hospital to Sub-Centre level), including newborn care units, immunization sessions, and IMNCI.
- Supported development of the district Newborn Action Plan and the Infant/Child Death Review system; supported Mission Indradhanush planning and district review forums.
- Authored the **“LOOP APPROACH” case study** (2015) proposing innovative district-level strategies to improve immunization coverage among marginalized and hard-to-reach communities (rag-pickers, urban poor, female sex workers), presented to the Mission Director, NRHM Haryana.

Earlier Clinical Background

- Homoeopathic Physician, Private Practice, New Delhi (2011– 2012/2014 — dates vary between source CVs; see note to candidate) — clinical practice following B.H.M.S. and rotatory internship.

EDUCATION

- Master of Population Studies (MPS) — International Institute for Population Sciences (IIPS), Mumbai, 2022
- Post Graduate Diploma in Health Care Management (PGDHHM) — International Institute of Health Management Research (IIHMR), New Delhi, 2014
- Bachelor of Homoeopathic Medicine & Surgery (B.H.M.S.) — Dr. B.R. Sur Homoeopathic Medical College, Hospital & Research Centre, GGSIPU, New Delhi, 2011

KEY CONTRIBUTIONS & PUBLICATIONS

- Contributed to the AB PM-JAY 2.0 reform framework design under ADB TA-9980 IND, including international benchmarking (2026).

- Contributed to development of NQAS process-acceleration tools for Sub Health Centre certification (2024).
- Contributed to IPHS 2022 and Swachh Swasth Sarvatra (SSS) National Guidelines (2021).
- Contributed to scale-up of the Mera Aspataal (My Hospital) initiative across states (2018–2021).
- Co-author, chapter on SAM Children's Advanced Care Guidance Document, AIIMS Bhopal (2018).
- Author, “LOOP APPROACH” case study on immunization coverage in vulnerable communities, presented to MD-NRHM Haryana (2015).

SKILLS & TOOLS

- Data & Information Systems: DHIS2, MCTS, HMIS, SNCU/MIDRS portals, SPSS, ODK, Advanced Excel
- Project Management Tools: JIRA, Asana, Microsoft Project, Monday, Workday
- Languages: English, Hindi

SELECTED TECHNICAL TRAININGS

Data Quality Assessment (ITSU/PHFI) · Effective Vaccine Management & Mission Indradhanush (GoI) · IMNCI Training-of-Trainers (PGI Chandigarh) · Research Ethics & Publications – REAP (AIIMS Delhi) · Soft Skills & Logframe Analysis (ACF-France) · VPD Surveillance (WHO) · Newborn Action Plan (IPE-Global) · Data Systems – DHIS2/MCTS/HMIS/SNCU/MIDRS (NHM Haryana, HFG-GoI, USAID)